

Preventing Psychosocial Risks in Your Team

Protecting your team's health, every day

4 psychology approaches · tips & guidance — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Protecting your team's health, every day

Chronic stress, overload, lack of recognition, conflict, insecurity: psychosocial risks (PSR) harm health and performance. The good news: a manager has real levers, day to day, to prevent them — without being an expert.

This guide helps you recognize your own relationship to stress, cultivate a protective culture, and activate concrete levers.

Your intention

A sign of tension/PSR you observe in your team: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

Your own relationship to stress

Your relationship to pressure rubs off on your team: if you run in permanent urgency or never switch off, you pass on that model, often without meaning to.

Becoming aware of it is the first prevention lever.

Example

Always 'full-on', Marc wondered at his team's stress. Realizing he set the tempo changed his stance.

My model

What relationship to stress/pressure am I passing on to my team?

What I want to embody

Write the stance you want to model (disconnecting, right to err, balance).

→ *The relationship to stress I embody rubs off on my team.*

The beliefs that worsen things

'Stress is normal, it motivates', 'it's not my problem', 'people must tough it out': these beliefs lead to denying the signals and let PSR set in.

Questioning them means no longer normalizing what harms.

Example

Sure 'a bit of pressure never killed anyone', Inès ignored the signals... until a sick leave. She revised her belief.

My beliefs

Which belief about stress might you tend to normalize?

Reframe

Turn 'it motivates' into 'some challenge motivates, but chronic stress harms'.

→ *Chronic stress isn't an engine — it's a risk.*

A protective culture

Recognition, psychological safety, listening, meaning: a culture that treats people as humans (not resources) prevents much of PSR.

We give our best where we feel respected and safe.

Example

By establishing the right to err and listening check-ins, Léa saw stress drop — and engagement rise.

My team culture

On recognition, psychological safety, listening, meaning: where is my team fragile?

A protective gesture

What concrete gesture of recognition/listening can you establish this week?

→ *A culture that respects and secures prevents PSR.*

Concrete levers

Concretely: spot the signals (absenteeism, disengagement, irritability, conflict), act on the organization (workload, role clarity, autonomy, support), create spaces to speak, direct, and lean on HR and occupational health.

Prevention acts on the organization, not only on individuals.

Example

By clarifying roles and rebalancing workload, Sofia eased tensions she'd thought were 'personality clashes'.

The signals & causes

Note: 2 observed signals · the possible organizational cause (workload, roles, autonomy, recognition).

My lever

Pick 1 organizational lever to activate + create a regular listening space.

→ *Spotting signals and acting on the organization — that's prevention.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Learn to spot the signals: fatigue, disengagement, irritability, absenteeism, conflict.
- Act on organizational causes (workload, role clarity, autonomy, recognition).
- Cultivate psychological safety (right to err, free speech).
- Set the example (disconnecting, balance): the model matters.
- Create regular listening spaces and direct to HR/occupational health.
- You're not a therapist, but a key prevention lever; this isn't legal/medical advice.

To fill in

Signals & causes

Observed signal	Possible organizational cause

My levers

Lever to activate	Listening space planned

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Recognize my own relationship to stress.

Week 2 — Question the normalizing beliefs.

Week 3 — Cultivate a protective culture.

Week 4 — Activate organizational levers.

Your plan in 3 lines

- The stance I want to embody:
- The signal I watch:
- The organizational lever I activate:

TO CLOSE

Spot, act on the organization, create safety — you protect your team.

Spot, act on the organization, create safety.

This guide is a coaching tool for managers — not a certified training, nor legal or medical advice. For health matters, rely on occupational health and qualified professionals. In case of serious distress or danger, contact emergency services immediately. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.